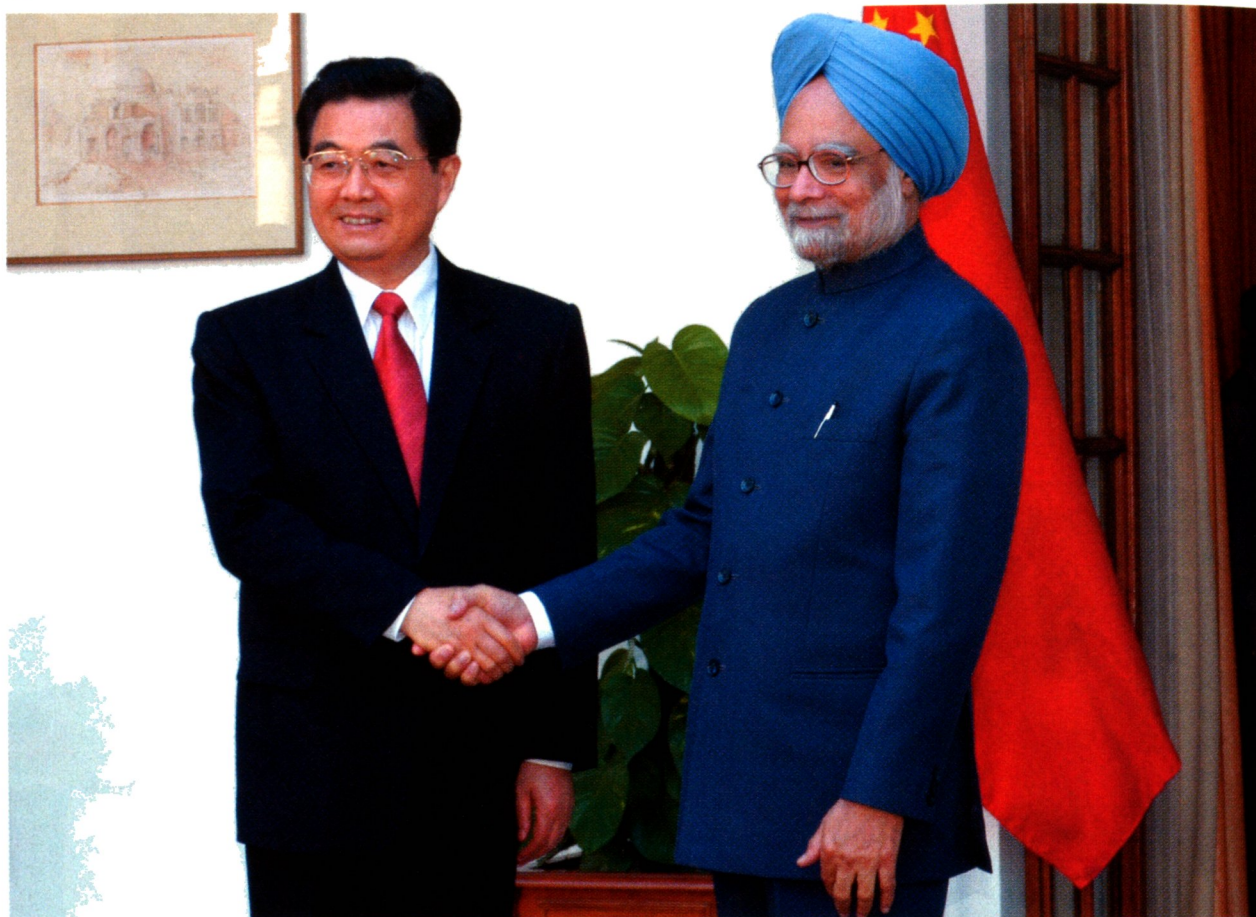




SIPRA DAS

DELHI | Passive-Aggressive

Despite the handshakes between Manmohan Singh and Chinese President Hu Jintao earlier this month, nothing has changed. The wall of mistrust continues to be an impediment in Indo-China relations. Intrusions by the Chinese forces continue unabated into Indian territory despite attempts by a red-faced South Block to brush them under the carpet. The most recent incursion occurred on September 30 at the Burste post in the Ladakh sector along the Sino-Indian boundary. Soldiers of the Chinese People's Liberation Army entered 15 km into India. While the transgression itself was unacceptable, the Chinese captured the patrolling base hut of Indian forces who were not present at the outpost. The patrolling base was burnt and rations and other equipment stolen. In another incident a fortnight ago, the Chinese PLA confronted Indian soldiers and asked them to "vacate Chinese sovereign territory". Alarming, according to a report sent to National Security Advisor M.K. Narayanan, the incursions tally has increased to 213 incidents, up from 170 reported last year. While the Chinese continue to maintain an aggressive posture, India's diplomatic response has been weak and tardy, which is certainly not the way an aspiring power behaves. *by Saurabh Shukla*

MANMOHAN
(ABOVE RIGHT)
WITH JINTAO

50

billion dollars
is the hit
taken by steel
magnate
Lakshmi
Mittal in the
US and
European
market
meltdown.